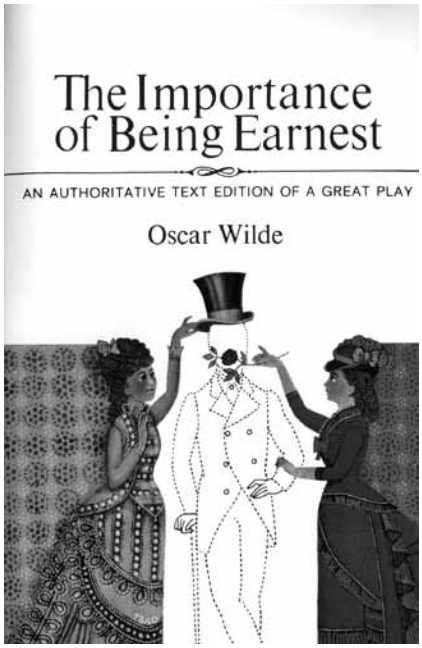
UNIVERSITY INTERSCHOLASTIC LEAGUE

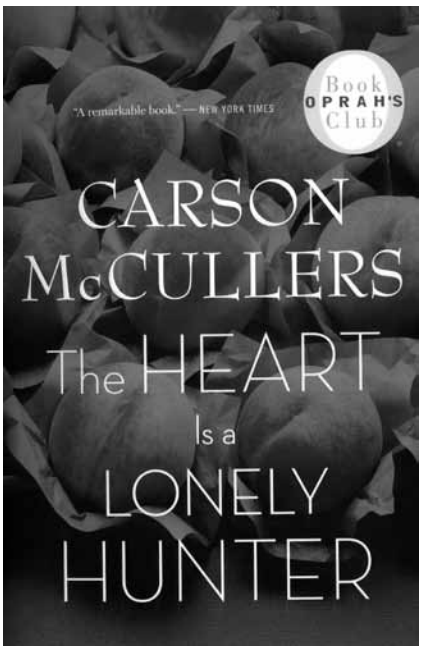
Making a World of Difference

Literary Criticism

Invitational B • 2013







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University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest • Invitational B • 2013

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1. The second half or resolution of a dramatic plot in which the failing fortunes of, for instance, the tragic hero are exhibited is called the

   A) exposition.
   B) falling action.
   C) moment of suspense.
   D) reversal.
   E) rising action.

2. The American author of *The Grapes of Wrath*, *Of Mice and Men*, and *East of Eden* who was awarded the 1962 Nobel Prize for Literature is

   A) William Faulkner.
   B) F. Scott Fitzgerald.
   C) Carson McCullers.
   D) John Steinbeck.
   E) William Styron.

3. A word formed by combining the initial letters or syllables of a series of words to form a name is a(n)

   A) acronym.
   B) anagram.
   C) ananym.
   D) anathema.
   E) heteronym.

4. Shakespeare's *Hamlet*, Marston's *Antonio's Revenge*, and Tourneur's *Atheist's Tragedy* represent the genre known as

   A) domestic tragedy.
   B) melodrama.
   C) revenge tragedy.
   D) romantic tragedy.
   E) tragicomedy.

5. A form of Japanese poetry, usually addressing either nature or one of its elements, that states—in three lines of five, seven, and five syllables—a clear picture designed to arouse a distinct emotion and suggest a specific spiritual insight, is the

   A) haiku.
   B) kabuki.
   C) kitsch.
   D) senryu.
   E) tanka.

6. The art of beautiful writing, which, during the Middle Ages, was developed by the monks who copied ancient manuscripts, is called

   A) alleography.
   B) calligraphy.
   C) epigraphy.
   D) hagiography.
   E) paleography.

7. The nineteenth-century American author of *The American*, *Daisy Miller*, *The Portrait of a Lady*, and *The Bostonians* is

   A) Stephen Crane.
   B) Theodore Dreiser.
   C) Henry James.
   D) Jack London.
   E) Frank Norris.

8. **Not** a term used, in some way, to hide the actual name of an author is

   A) allonym.
   B) nom de plume.
   C) pseudonym.
   D) putative author.
   E) *redende name*.

9. The poetic treatment of shepherds and rustic life, or in modern poetry, any poem of rural people and setting, is the essence of the

   A) burlesque.
   B) carnivalesque.
   C) elegiac.
   D) pastoral.
   E) rhopalic.

10. The diverse body of national literature whose early representation is greater in bulk, earlier in date, and more striking in character than any other preserved vernacular Western European literature is

    A) English literature.
    B) Gallic literature.
    C) Irish literature.
    D) Scottish literature.
    E) Welsh literature.

11. The stanza usually consisting of four lines rhyming *abcb*, with the first and third lines carrying four accents and the fourth carrying three, is the

A) ballad stanza.
B) chain verse.
C) nonsense verse.
D) pantoum.
E) philippic.

12. The late-nineteenth-century literary movement that applies the principles of scientific determinism to literature is known as

A) naturalism.
B) neologism.
C) realism.
D) romanticism.
E) structuralism.

13. The award-winning translator of French literature and author of the poetry collection *Untitled Subjects*, which earned him the 1970 Pulitzer Prize, is

A) John Ashbery.
B) John Berryman.
C) Stephen Dunn.
D) Anthony Hecht.
E) Richard Howard.

14. The system of manners and morals, which as a product of medieval feudalism, characterizes, in a highly idealized form, medieval romance is

A) Byronism.
B) chivalry.
C) decadence.
D) patronage.
E) ratiocination.

15. A term used, often narrowly, to suggest a certain complacency, hypocrisy, or squeamishness assumed to characterize the attitudes of the last half of the nineteenth century in Britain, all of which are apparent in the cautious manner with which writers treat such matters as profanity and sex, is

A) comstockery.
B) hedonism.
C) meliorism.
D) Puritanism.
E) Victorian.

16. Writing having to do with any scattering of a population from a homeland to one or more alien environments is known as

A) *chanson d'aventure*.
B) comparative literature.
C) diasporic literature.
D) picaresque.
E) regionalism.

17. **Not** a novel written by nineteenth- and twentieth-century English poet and novelist Thomas Hardy is

A) *Adam Bede*.
B) *The Mayor of Casterbridge*.
C) *The Return of the Native*.
D) *Tess of the d'Urbervilles*.
E) *Under the Greenwood Tree*.

18. The placing of a sentence element out of its normal position, often to accommodate a poem's rhyme scheme and rhythm, is called

A) abridgement.
B) boustrophedon.
C) inversion.
D) redaction.
E) reversal.

19. The name applied in derision to a group of nineteenth-century English novelists who emphasize gentility and etiquette in their novels is

A) Satanic School.
B) Saturday Club.
C) Scriblerus Club.
D) Silver-Fork School.
E) *Sturm und Drang*.

20. The turn in thought—from question to answer; problem to solution—that usually occurs at the beginning of the sestet in the Italian sonnet and between, though not always, the twelfth and the thirteenth lines in the Shakespearean sonnet is the

A) device.
B) hypotaxis.
C) inversion.
D) peripety.
E) volta.

21. The name applied in general to the age of England's Charles I and in particular to the spirit of his court, including the literature of the time, is

A) Augustan.
B) Caroline.
C) Jacobean.
D) Restoration.
E) Tudor.

22. Set during the American Civil War and Reconstruction and often referred to as the American epic, the romance novel *Gone with the Wind*'s success garnered the 1937 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction for

A) Willa Cather.
B) Margaret Mitchell.
C) Julia Peterkin.
D) Katherine Anne Porter.
E) Edith Wharton.

23. The final unraveling of a plot, the solution of a mystery, or an explanation or outcome is known as the

A) *débat*.
B) *de casibus*.
C) *dénouement*.
D) *deus ex machina*.
E) *dolce stil nuovo*.

24. The particular kind of drama that presents the ridiculousness and the meaninglessness of the human condition by an abandoning of the usual or rational dramatic and narrative devices is

A) bourgeois drama.
B) *coup de théâtre*.
C) dramatic irony.
D) patent theater.
E) Theater of the Absurd.

25. In prosody, the emphasis given to a syllable in articulation is called a(n)

A) accent.
B) breve.
C) caesura.
D) diastole.
E) expletive.

26. A poem written as though to be sung by a group and characteristically lacking an exciting dramatic narrative is a

A) ballad.
B) doggerel.
C) glee.
D) mad song.
E) map poem.

27. The period in English literature between the return of the Stuarts to the English throne in 1660 and the publication of Coleridge and Wordsworth's *Lyrical Ballads* in 1798 is the

A) Commonwealth and Interregnum.
B) Neoclassic Period.
C) Realistic Period.
D) Renaissance.
E) Romantic Period.

28. Literature—usually prose fiction—entirely or partly written as letters (not alphabetic characters) is known as (a)

A) documentary novel.
B) epistolary literature.
C) narratology.
D) transliteration.
E) vignette.

29. In literature, the genre whose fidelity to a particular geographical area successfully represents and portrays that area's habits, speech, manners, history, folklore, and beliefs is

A) frontier literature.
B) primitivism.
C) provincialism.
D) regionalism.
E) spectacle.

30. **Not** one of Eugene O'Neill's Pulitzer Prize-winning dramas is

A) *Anna Christie* (1922).
B) *Beyond the Horizon* (1920).
C) *Long Day's Journey into Night* (1957).
D) *Strange Interlude* (1928).
E) *A Streetcar Named Desire* (1948).

Part 2: The UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

Items 31-37 are associated with Oscar Wilde's *The Importance of Being Earnest*.
Items 38-44 are associated with Carson McCullers's *The Heart Is a Lonely Hunter*.
Items 45-50 are associated with Samuel Taylor Coleridge's poetry (selected).

31. In Wilde's *Importance of Being Earnest* the assertion that a girl's diary is a "record of her thoughts and impressions, and consequently meant for publication" is made by

A) Lady Bracknell.
B) Mr. Bunbury.
C) Cecily.
D) Gwendolen.
E) Laetitia.

32. The proper way to eat muffins is the subject of a conversation between Algernon and

A) Cecily.
B) Chasuble.
C) Gwendolen.
D) Jack.
E) Merriman.

33. During Lady Bracknell's interviewing of Jack regarding Cecily's qualifications for marriage, Cecily becomes a "most attractive young lady" in Bracknell's opinion only after she learns that

A) Cecily has competed in UIL Literary Criticism.
B) Cecily has money in the Funds.
C) Cecily is a Cardew of Cardiff Street.
D) Cecily is a Cardew of Grosvenor Square.
E) Cecily is recently divorced.

34. Jack tells Algy that he has "been writing frantic letters" regarding the loss of his cigarette case to

A) the Brighton Line lost and found.
B) the Bunbury lost and found.
C) Scotland Yard.
D) the Shropshire constabulary.
E) Tunbridge Wells.

35. Miss Cardew, when discovered watering the flowers instead of studying, complains to Miss Prism that "I look quite plain after my

A) economics lesson."
B) genealogy lesson."
C) geography lesson."
D) German lesson."
E) theology lesson."

36. Miss Cardew informs her Uncle Jack's "younger brother" that in addition to the brother's good taste, their relationship has continued, in part, because she has been forced to

A) accept that Ernest is a good middle name.
B) butter all the muffins herself.
C) ignore the fact that he has not returned her calls.
D) pay his debts.
E) write his letters herself.

37. Chasuble explains his attempt to flatter Mrs. Prism in addressing her as Egeria as a use of

A) allusion.
B) euphemism.
C) malapropism.
D) *redende name*.
E) spoonerism.

38. In McCullers's *Heart Is a Lonely Hunter* the characters whose awareness of the world beyond their immediate environment is the greatest are

A) Antonapoulos and Singer.
B) Biff and Copeland.
C) Harry and Blount.
D) Mick and Portia.
E) Willie and Highboy.

39. McCullers sets the lives of her many characters against the background of the years

A) during World War I.
B) during World War II.
C) immediately after Reconstruction.
D) immediately following the Great Crash.
E) immediately prior to World War II.

40. The Kelly family's concern for money precipitates Mick's having to take a job at the ten-cent store named

A) American Dime.
B) Family Dime.
C) the New York Café.
D) Sunny Dixie Show.
E) Woolworth's.

41. The newspaper employment advertisement reading, "Wanted—Experienced Mechanic. Sunny Dixie Show. Apply Corner Weavers Lane & 15th Street," catches the attention of

A) Jake Blount.
B) Biff Brannon.
C) Willie Copeland.
D) Walt Kelly.
E) Harry Minowitz.

42. McCullers's ***reader*** gets a sense that the relationships most, if not all, the characters have with Singer are not quite what they believe them to be while

A) listening to Antonapoulos talk to Singer.
B) listening to the radio with Mick.
C) reading Mick's diary.
D) reading Singer's last will and testament.
E) reading Singer's letter to Antonapoulos.

43. "There are those who know and those who don't know. And for every ten thousand who don't know there's only one who knows. That's the miracle of all time—" constitutes

A) Blount's estimation of Brannon and himself.
B) Blount's estimation of Copeland.
C) Blount's estimation of himself.
D) Blount's estimation of Singer and himself
E) Blount's estimation of Singer and Mick.

44. Blount's insulting observation, "You live a fine life. Just standing behind a cash register. Just standing with your hand open," is directed at

A) Alice Brannon.
B) Biff Brannon.
C) Mick Kelly.
D) Leroy Wilson.
E) Lucile Wilson.

Items 45-50 refer to Samuel Taylor Coleridge's

The Nightingale (excerpted)

No cloud, no relique of the sunken day
Distinguishes the West, no long thin slip
Of sullen light, no obscure trembling hues.
Come, we will rest on this old mossy bridge!
You see the glimmer of the stream beneath,
But hear no murmuring: it flows silently.
O'er its soft bed of verdure. All is still.
A balmy night! and though the stars be dim,
Yet let us think upon the vernal showers
That gladden the green earth, and we shall find
A pleasure in the dimness of the stars.
And hark! the Nightingale begins its song,
'Most musical, most melancholy' bird!
A melancholy bird? Oh! idle thought!
In Nature there is nothing melancholy.
But some night-wandering man whose heart was pierced
With the remembrance of a grievous wrong,
Or slow distemper, or neglected love,
(And so, poor wretch! filled all things with himself,
And made all gentle sounds tell back the tale
Of his own sorrow) he, and such as he,
First named these notes a melancholy strain.
And many a poet echoes the conceit;
Poet who hath been building up the rhyme
When he had better far have stretched his limbs
Beside a brook in mossy forest-dell,
By sun or moon-light, to the influxes
Of shapes and sounds and shifting elements
Surrendering his whole spirit, of his song
And of his fame forgetful! so his fame
Should share in Nature's immortality,
A venerable thing! and so his song
Should make all Nature lovelier, and itself
Be loved like Nature! But 'twill not be so;
And youths and maidens most poetical,
Who lose the deepening twilights of the spring
In ball-rooms and hot theatres, they still
Full of meek sympathy must heave their sighs
O'er Philomela's pity-pleading strains.

45. Coleridge's invitation to "rest on this old mossy bridge" (line 4) begins a sequence of statements, all of which designate the poem as an example of

A) apostrophe.
B) metonymy.
C) rhetorical accent.
D) synaesthesia.
E) synecdoche.

46. Coleridge takes issue with the traditional notion that the nightingale is a "most melancholy" bird (line 13), countering, "In Nature there is nothing melancholy" (line 15), which is effectively an argument against

A) animism.
B) anthropomorphism.
C) hyperbole.
D) irony.
E) syllepsis.

47. Coleridge's conversational poem "The Nightingale" is set

A) at noon.
B) during the wee hours of the morning.
C) in the afternoon.
D) in the late, late evening.
E) in the morning.

48. The two types of imagery not informing lines 1-32 of "The Nightingale" are

A) gustatory and olfactory.
B) tactile and auditory.
C) tactile and olfactory.
D) visual and auditory.
E) visual and tactile.

49. The *murmuring* of line 6, "But hear no murmuring," is an instance of

A) assonance.
B) consonance.
C) onomatopoeia.
D) verisimilitude.
E) wrenched accent.

50. The *strains* of lines 22 and 39 are

A) bagpipes droning.
B) conceits.
C) overreachings.
D) poetic expressions.
E) pulled muscles.

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism
15 items (2 points each)

Items 51-55 refer to Ralph Waldo Emerson's

Loss and Gain

Virtue runs before the muse
And defies her skill,
She is rapt, and doth refuse
To wait a painter's will. 4

Star-adoring, occupied,
Virtue cannot bend her,
Just to please a poet's pride,
To parade her splendor. 8

The bard must be with good intent
No more his, but hers,
Throw away his pen and paint,
Kneel with worshippers. 12

Then, perchance, a sunny ray
From the heaven of fire,
His lost tools may over-pay,
And better his desire. 16

51. The muse to which Emerson's persona refers in the first line of "Loss and Gain" is one of the

A) four major tropes.
B) four senses of interpretation.
C) four subjects constituting the quadrivium.
D) nine minor Greek goddesses of inspiration.
E) seven liberal arts.

52. The treatment of the abstraction virtue as if it has a concrete form constitutes

A) anthropomorphism.
B) hendiadys.
C) kenosis.
D) prosopopoeia.
E) reification.

53. The bard introduced in line 9 is a(n)

A) astronomer.
B) carpenter.
C) painter.
D) poet.
E) worshipper.

54. The auditory scheme that characterizes line 7, especially, and which is echoed throughout the poem is

A) alliteration.
B) consonance.
C) dissonance.
D) homeoteleuton.
E) onomatopoeia.

55. Lines 6 and 8 exhibit

A) compound rhyme.
B) feminine rhyme.
C) internal rhyme.
D) masculine rhyme.
E) slant rhyme.

Items 56-61 refer to
Henry Wadsworth Longfellow's

Snow-flakes

Out of the bosom of the Air,
Out of the cloud-folds of her garments shaken,
Over the woodlands brown and bare,
Over the harvest-fields forsaken,
Silent, and soft, and slow
Descends the snow.

Even as our cloudy fancies take
Suddenly shape in some divine expression,
Even as the troubled heart doth make
In the white countenance confession,
The troubled sky reveals
The grief it feels.

This is the poem of the air,
Slowly in silent syllables recorded;
This is the secret of despair,
Long in its cloudy bosom hoarded,
Now whispered and revealed
To wood and field.

56. The repetition of line beginnings that characterizes much of Longfellow's "Snow-flakes" is known as

A) anaphora.
B) epanalepsis.
C) merism.
D) ploce.
E) polyptoton.

57. The three-syllable foot that introduces the first four lines of each of the poem's stanzas is the

A) anapest.
B) dactyl.
C) iamb.
D) spondee.
E) trochee.

58. The rhyme scheme of Longfellow's lyric poem "Snow-flakes" is

A) *ababba*.
B) *ababbc*.
C) *ababcc*.
D) *abbacc*.
E) *abbcaa*.

59. The type of rhyme dominating Longfellow's "Snow-flakes" is

A) compound rhyme.
B) eye rhyme.
C) feminine rhyme.
D) internal rhyme.
E) masculine rhyme.

60. The *fancy* of Longfellow's "cloudy fancies" (line 7) is

A) the constellations.
B) the emotions.
C) the imagination.
D) meteorological hors d'oeuvres.
E) storm clouds.

61. The phrase "silent syllables recorded" (line 14) constitutes a(n)

A) equivoque.
B) hyperbole.
C) litotes.
D) oxymoron.
E) paradox.

Invitational B (items 62-65) continues on the next page.

Items 62-65 refer to John Masefield's

Sea-Fever

I must go down to the seas again, to the lonely sea and the sky,
And all I ask is a tall ship and a star to steer her by,
And the wheel's kick and the wind's song and the white sail's shaking,
And a grey mist on the sea's face, and a grey dawn breaking. 4

I must go down to the seas again, for the call of the running tide
Is a wild call and a clear call that may not be denied;
And all I ask is a windy day with the white clouds flying,
And the flung spray and the blown spume, and the sea-gulls crying. 8

I must go down to the seas again, to the vagrant gypsy life,
To the gull's way and the whale's way, where the wind's like a whetted knife;
And all I ask is a merry yarn from a laughing fellow-rover,
And quiet sleep and a sweet dream when the long trick's over. 12

62. The auditory scheme, the melopoeia, that drives Masefield's "Sea-Fever" is

A) alliteration.
B) cacophony.
C) dissonance.
D) onomatopoeia.
E) syncopation.

63. The diction and the imagery of the poem suggest that the persona was once a

A) doctor.
B) marine biologist.
C) poet.
D) sailor.
E) whaler.

64. **Not** contributing to the overall effect of Masefield's poem is

A) alliteration.
B) imagery.
C) kenning.
D) oxymoron.
E) simile.

65. The essence of the last line of John Masefield's poem, "quiet sleep and a sweet dream," suggests

A) amnesia.
B) death.
C) drowning.
D) insomnia.
E) seasickness.

Required tie-breaking essay prompt on the next page.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay (required)

Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie.

Note well: Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.

Three sheets of paper have been provided for this essay; your written response should reflect the *Handbook*'s notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than just a few sentences.

Read Samuel Taylor Coleridge's "To the Autumnal Moon," and offer a discussion of the poet's comparison of hope to the moon.

To the Autumnal Moon

Mild Splendour of the various-vested Night!
Mother of wildly-working visions! hail!
I watch thy gliding, while with watery light
Thy weak eye glimmers through a fleecy veil;
And when thou lovest thy pale orb to shroud
Behind the gather'd blackness lost on high;
And when thou dartest from the wind-rent cloud
Thy placid lightning o'er th' awakened sky.
Ah, such is Hope! as changeful and as fair!
Now dimly peering on the wistful sight;
Now hid behind the dragon-winged Despair:
But soon emerging in her radiant might
She o'er the sorrow-clouded breast of Care
Sails, like a meteor kindling in its flight.

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Literary Criticism Contest
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KEY

Page numbers are those associated with the *Handbook* 12e, the Mariner 2000 edition of *Heart*, and the Avon 1965 edition of *Earnest*.

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1.	B	193	11.	A	49	21.	B	75
2.	D	600	12.	A	315	22.	B	602
3.	A	4	13.	E	605	23.	C	135
4.	C	409	14.	B	85	24.	E	2
5.	A	225	15.	E	496	25.	A	3
6.	B	72	16.	C	140	26.	C	218
7.	C	565+	17.	A	562	27.	B	320
8.	E	403	18.	C	257	28.	B	179
9.	D	354	19.	D	445	29.	D	405
10.	C	258	20.	E	498	30.	E	607

Part 2: UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

31.	C	73	38.	C		45.	A	37
32.	D	88	39.	E		46.	B	30
33.	B	97	40.	E	315	47.	D	
34.	C	31	41.	A	59	48.	A	
35.	D	56	42.	E	215	49.	C	337
36.	E	75	43.	D	24	50.	D	
37.	A	59	44.	B	227			

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism **15 items (2 points each)**

51.	D	310	56.	A	24	61.	E	349
52.	E	405	57.	B	129	62.	A	13
53.	D	50	58.	C		63.	D	
54.	A	13	59.	E	287	64.	D	345
55.	B	196	60.	C		65.	B	

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

the degree to which the instructions have been followed,

the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,

the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and

the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

Critical Notes on Samuel Taylor Coleridge's "To the Autumnal Moon"

Literary concepts that MIGHT be used by the contestant in a discussion of Coleridge's poem include

alliteration,
ambiguity,
analogy,
apostrophe,
assonance,
controlling image,
diction,
imagination,
iambic pentameter,
meter,
muse,
octave,
personification,
reification,
rhyme,
rhythm,
sestet,
sigmatism,
simile,
sonnet,
synaesthesia,
tenor,
tone,
vehicle,
visual imagery, and
volta.

The contestant has been asked to discuss the poet's comparison of hope to the moon.

The young writer should recognize the turn in thought (the volta) that begins the sonnet's sestet: "Ah, such is Hope! as changeful, and as fair!" (line 9). The ever-changing moon, the "Mother of wildly-working visions" (line 2) serves as the vehicle in the comparison that is the poem. Hope, changeful and fair (line 9), is the tenor. The student's comparison can dwell, and successfully so, on the visual imagery of both the moon as a "weak eye glimmer[ing] through a fleecy veil"—the clouds (line 4) and Hope's peering and "hid[ing] behind the dragon-winged Despair" (lines 10-11), as well as on Hope's emerging "o'er sorrow-clouded breast of Care" (line 13).

The student might opt to discuss the comparison in terms of reification, wherein Hope and Despair and Care, all abstractions, are treated as concrete objects in the persona's comparing Hope to the literal moon. The triumph of Hope (line 14) is described in astronomical terms that render the "mild splendor" (line 1) and the "placid lightning" (line 8) inferior (line 14) to the power ("like a meteor kindling in its flight") of the poet's imagination (by analogy, the "wildly-working visions")—a poetic imagination ultimately responsible for the comparison in the poem.

The optimism resonating in the poem's title (later to be immortalized in Shelley's "can Spring be far behind?") might engender some speculation regarding the poem's tone.